How to Make Money from TikTok: 10 Legit Ways to Start Earning in 2026

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Short Answer: TikTok creators can earn income by joining eligible monetization programs, promoting products through affiliate links, working with brands, and creating sponsored videos.If you spend time creating TikTok videos, you may eventually start wondering **how to make money from TikTok**. The good news is that TikTok can be more than a platform for entertainment and short videos. Depending on your location, audience, content, and eligibility, there are several ways to turn your TikTok presence into an income stream.

TikTok creators can explore official monetization programs, brand sponsorships, affiliate marketing, LIVE features, product sales, and even services outside the platform. You do not necessarily need millions of followers to begin exploring these options.

In this guide, we'll cover **10 legit ways to make money from TikTok in 2026**, along with practical tips for choosing a monetization method that fits your content.

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1. Use TikTok's Creator Rewards Program

One of the first options to investigate when learning **how to make money from TikTok** is TikTok's Creator Rewards Program.

The program is designed to reward eligible creators for qualifying original content. Availability and requirements depend on the creator's country and account eligibility.

The older term **TikTok Creator Fund** is still widely searched online, but TikTok has moved toward the Creator Rewards Program in markets where it is available.

If you see the program available in your TikTok creator tools, review the current requirements before applying.

What can affect creator rewards?

Depending on the applicable program rules, factors can include:

* Qualified video views
* Originality of content
* Video engagement
* Account eligibility
* Location
* Compliance with TikTok's policies

Do not assume that every view automatically produces earnings. Qualified views and program-specific rules are what matter.

2. Earn Through TikTok LIVE

TikTok LIVE gives eligible creators another way to interact with their audience in real time.

Creators can use LIVE sessions for:

* Q&A sessions
* Gaming
* Tutorials
* Entertainment
* Product demonstrations
* Music
* Discussions
* Behind-the-scenes content

Eligible viewers may be able to send virtual gifts during LIVE sessions, and creators may receive rewards according to TikTok's applicable rules.

A successful LIVE strategy usually depends on audience engagement rather than simply starting a stream and waiting for viewers.

Try giving each LIVE session a clear topic so viewers understand why they should stay.

3. Get Paid by Brands

Brand sponsorships are another popular way of **making money on TikTok**.

Companies may pay creators to feature their products or services in videos when the creator's audience matches the brand's target market.

You don't always need a huge following.

A creator with a focused audience can be attractive to brands because the content may reach a specific group of potential customers.

For example, a technology creator could work with:

* Smartphone companies
* Software brands
* Accessory manufacturers
* Gaming companies
* Online services

A beauty creator could potentially work with cosmetics, skincare, or fashion brands.

The amount offered for a campaign varies widely based on factors such as audience size, engagement, niche, content requirements, usage rights, and location.

Always disclose paid partnerships appropriately.

4. Try Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing is another practical answer to **how to make money from TikTok**.

With affiliate marketing, you promote a product or service using a tracking link or other approved method. If someone makes a qualifying purchase through your referral, you may receive a commission.

For example, a gaming creator could recommend:

* Gaming headphones
* Keyboards
* Controllers
* Gaming chairs
* Accessories

A fitness creator might promote workout equipment, while a technology creator could recommend useful apps or gadgets.

The most important rule is relevance.

If your account is about gaming, promoting unrelated products simply because they have high commissions may not work well with your audience.

5. Sell Your Own Products

TikTok can also be used to promote products you create or sell.

These could include physical or digital products such as:

* Clothing
* Accessories
* Artwork
* Templates
* Ebooks
* Guides
* Courses
* Print-on-demand products

For example, a drawing creator could create TikTok videos showing simple drawing techniques and direct interested viewers toward printable drawing resources.

A cooking creator could create recipe videos and offer a digital recipe collection.

The TikTok video becomes the discovery mechanism, while the product creates the potential revenue.

6. Promote Your Services

You can make money from TikTok without selling a physical product.

If you have a professional skill, TikTok can help you find potential clients.

Some examples include:

* Graphic design
* Video editing
* SEO
* Website development
* Photography
* Tutoring
* Coaching
* Social media management
* Writing
* Consulting

Suppose you are a video editor. Instead of simply saying that you provide editing services, you could create short before-and-after editing demonstrations.

This gives potential customers an immediate example of what you can do.

In this situation, TikTok may not pay you directly. Instead, the platform helps you generate leads for your business.

7. Build a Niche TikTok Account

One of the easiest ways to make your TikTok strategy more focused is to choose a niche.

A niche gives your audience a clear reason to follow your account.

Popular content categories include:

Gaming

Create game guides, updates, tips, tutorials, reviews, and gameplay videos.

Technology

Share app recommendations, gadget reviews, tutorials, and technology news.

Fitness

Post workouts, exercise explanations, healthy lifestyle content, and training tips.

Food

Create recipes, cooking demonstrations, food reviews, and meal ideas.

Fashion

Share styling ideas, outfit inspiration, product recommendations, and trends.

Education

Create short lessons, explanations, study tips, and useful educational content.

A niche can also make it easier to identify relevant brands and affiliate products.

8. Use TikTok to Send Traffic to Your Website

TikTok can act as a traffic source for another online business.

You might use videos to introduce people to:

* A blog
* An online store
* A newsletter
* An app
* A service business
* A course
* A membership
* A digital product

For example, an SEO website could publish short TikTok videos explaining search optimization tips. Interested viewers could then visit the full guide on the website.

This strategy means your TikTok account does not have to generate every dollar directly.

Instead, TikTok can become the top of your marketing funnel.

9. Create Content for Businesses

Not every way of **making money on TikTok** requires building your own large audience.

Businesses also need people who understand short-form video.

If you are good at creating TikTok-style videos, you can offer content creation services to businesses.

You might create:

* Product videos
* Demonstration videos
* Educational clips
* Short advertisements
* UGC-style content
* Social media videos

A company may use your content on its own TikTok account or other marketing channels, depending on the agreement.

This can be an option for creators who are comfortable making videos but don't yet have a large personal following.

10. Repurpose Your Original Content

Another way to increase the value of your TikTok work is to adapt your original videos for other platforms.

For example:

TikTok → YouTube Shorts → Instagram Reels → Facebook Reels

Instead of creating completely different videos for every platform, you can adapt your original content while following each platform's policies and formatting requirements.

This can help you reach more people and create additional opportunities for monetization.

However, avoid simply copying content that you do not own. Use your own original material or content for which you have the appropriate rights.

How to Make Money on TikTok Without Followers

A common question is whether you need thousands or millions of followers before you can make money.

Not necessarily.

Some monetization methods depend heavily on audience size, while others are based more on your skills, products, services, or ability to generate conversions.

For example, a person with a relatively small audience might earn through:

* Freelance services
* Affiliate marketing
* Digital products
* Consulting
* Product sales

Meanwhile, larger creators may have additional opportunities involving sponsorships and platform monetization programs.

The important thing is to match your monetization method with your current audience and capabilities.

How to Make Money on TikTok Videos

If your main goal is to monetize TikTok videos, focus on content that people actually want to watch.

Useful formats include:

Tutorials

Teach viewers something in a simple, easy-to-follow format.

Reviews

Explain the advantages and disadvantages of a product, app, or service.

Comparisons

Compare two products or approaches and explain the differences.

How-To Videos

Show viewers how to complete a task or solve a common problem.

List Videos

Create short lists such as "5 useful apps" or "7 gaming accessories."

Demonstrations

Show the product, technique, or process instead of simply talking about it.

These formats can make it easier to incorporate relevant affiliate products, sponsorships, or services naturally.

How to Get Monetized on TikTok

If you're specifically searching for **how to get monetized on TikTok**, start by checking your account's available monetization features.

Open TikTok and explore the creator tools or TikTok Studio section. Depending on your location and eligibility, you may see different options.

Potential steps include:

1. Create original content consistently.
2. Build a genuine audience.
3. Follow TikTok's Community Guidelines.
4. Check available creator monetization programs.
5. Review the eligibility requirements.
6. Apply when your account qualifies.
7. Continue monitoring your creator dashboard.

Requirements can change, so don't rely on an old follower or view threshold found in an outdated article.

What Is the TikTok Creator Fund?

The **TikTok Creator Fund** is an older monetization term that many people still use when searching for ways to get paid for TikTok content.

TikTok has introduced the Creator Rewards Program in markets where it is available.

If you're researching the Creator Fund, check TikTok's current creator monetization options instead of assuming older program information still applies to your account.

The available programs can depend on your country and other eligibility requirements.

Creator Rewards Program in the Philippines

Creators in the Philippines searching for information about the **Creator Rewards Program in the Philippines** should check the current availability and eligibility shown by TikTok for their account.

TikTok monetization features are not necessarily identical in every country.

Before relying on a specific program as an income source, confirm that the program is currently available in your region and review its latest requirements.

How Much Money Can You Make From TikTok?

There is no universal amount that every creator can earn.

Income depends on the monetization method.

For example, creator-program earnings may depend on qualified views and program rules. Brand deals depend on the campaign and creator's audience. Affiliate earnings depend on conversions and commission rates. A service business depends on the number and value of clients.

This means two creators with similar follower counts can potentially have very different incomes.

Instead of focusing only on follower numbers, consider:

Audience + engagement + niche + monetization method + conversions

Together, these factors provide a better picture of earning potential.

Tips for Making Money from TikTok

1. Pick a clear niche

A focused topic makes it easier to understand your audience.

2. Create consistently

Regular publishing gives you more opportunities to discover which content performs well.

3. Make the first few seconds useful

People scroll quickly, so get to the main point instead of using a long introduction.

4. Don't over-promote

If every video feels like an advertisement, viewers may lose interest.

5. Build trust

Only recommend products, services, or businesses that are relevant to your audience.

6. Track your results

Look beyond views. Monitor engagement, clicks, conversions, and follower growth.

7. Diversify

Do not depend entirely on one TikTok monetization feature.

Common Mistakes to Avoid

Trying to make money from TikTok can become difficult if you focus on shortcuts rather than building a real audience.

Avoid:

* Buying fake followers
* Buying fake views
* Using stolen videos
* Making misleading income claims
* Promoting irrelevant products
* Ignoring copyright rules
* Spamming affiliate links
* Copying other creators without adding original value

Fake engagement may increase a number temporarily, but it does not create a genuine audience that can support long-term monetization.

Frequently Asked Questions

How do you make money on TikTok?

You can potentially make money through creator monetization programs, LIVE features, sponsorships, affiliate marketing, product sales, services, and other business

opportunities.

How can I make money from TikTok without going viral?
You can focus on a specific niche and monetize through affiliate products, services, digital products, sponsorships, or other relevant opportunities. Viral content is not the only path to earning.

Can you make money on TikTok with 1,000 followers?
It depends on the monetization method and your location. Some official programs have specific eligibility requirements, while affiliate marketing, services, and product sales can work differently.

How do you get monetized on TikTok?
Check the monetization features available in your TikTok creator tools and review the current eligibility requirements. Availability varies by region and program.

Does TikTok pay for every view?
No. Not every view automatically results in payment. Eligible creator programs use their own rules regarding qualified views and rewards.

Is the TikTok Creator Fund still available?
TikTok has moved toward the Creator Rewards Program in markets where it is available. The exact monetization options depend on your country and account eligibility.

Final Thoughts

Learning **how to make money from TikTok** is less about finding one secret method and more about choosing the right monetization strategy for your content.

Creator rewards, LIVE features, sponsorships, affiliate marketing, product sales, services, and website traffic can all play different roles in a TikTok income strategy.

Start with useful original content, build a specific audience, follow TikTok's current rules, and choose monetization methods that naturally fit your niche. As your audience grows, you can test additional income streams instead of depending on a single source.

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